



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

May 27, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:31 p.m. by Mayor Daniel Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy Davis*

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, City Assessor Jason Yoakam, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Chris Simpson, and City Engineer Troy White.

Councilmember Davis arrived after the initial roll call

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood to adopt the agenda. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS:

A. Water and Wastewater Rate Studies

Bendzinski & Co. Municipal Finance Advisors presented an overview of their water and wastewater rate study.

PUBLIC HEARINGS: none.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

Councilmember Davis arrived at 7:27 p.m.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to take a 3 minute recess. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Council was recessed from 7:41 p.m. – 7:47 p.m.

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Wood to return from recess. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Minutes of the May 8, 2025, Budget Workshop

Approve the minutes from the May 8, 2025 Budget Workshop

B. Minutes of the May 13, 2025, Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council

Approve the May 13, 2025, minutes of the regular meeting of the Jackson City Council.

C. Corrective Resolution - Council Meeting Dates

Approve a resolution correcting the 2025 City Council Meeting Dates Schedule.

D. Traffic Control Order 2405

Approve Traffic Control Order 2405 installing Autistic Child signs on Merriman Street between Wall Street and Damon Street.

E. Special Event Application: Pathway Kids Club

Approve a request from the Ganson Street Baptist Church to host the Pathway Kids Club, June 23-27, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

F. Special Event Application: Revival in the Park

Approve a request from Connections 4 Christ to host the Revival in the Park on June 7, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

G. Special Event Application: Fall Gala

Approve a request from the Jackson Community Foundation to host the Fall Gala on September 19, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

H. Special Event Application: Food Truck Fridays

Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the Food Truck Fridays on May 23, June 27, July 25, August 22, and September 26, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

I. Special Event Application: Food Truck Tuesdays

Approve a request from Melted Grill, LLC to host the Food Truck Tuesdays on June 10, June 24, July 22, August 5, and August 19, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

J. Special Event Application: Sacred Heart Community Festival

Approve a request from the Sacred Heart Community Church to host the Sacred Heart Community Festival on June 29, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

K. Special Event Application: Paws in the Park

Approve a request from the Cascades Human Society to host the Paws in the Park on June 21, 2025, at Cascades Park.

L. Special Event Application: June Cruise-In and Concert

Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the June Cruise-In and Concert, in downtown Jackson.

M. Special Event Application: Grand River Farmers Market - Children's Market

Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the Grand River Farmers Market-Children's Market, in downtown Jackson.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. East Side Economic Development Update

City Manager Jonathan Greene gave an update of the status of efforts being made.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. Resolution to Establish Licensing Fees for Electric Scooters

Recommendation: *Adopt the Resolution establishing the annual licensing fee and non-compliance penalty for electric scooters under City Ordinance 2025-1*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to adopt the resolution establishing the annual licensing fee and non-compliance penalty for electric scooters under City Ordinance 2025-1.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to amend Section 2 to have the second sentence read, in full, “an additional fee in the amount of \$100 shall be paid to the City each day (rather than month) for each electric scooter which has remained impounded by the City for more than 7 (rather than 30) days after notice has been sent to the licensed company notifying them of the impoundment.” Vote – Yeas: Wood and Forgrave (2). Nays: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, and Davis (5). Motion failed.

Vote was taken on the main motion. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Resolution - Delinquent Invoices 2025 Summer Tax Bill

Recommendation: *Approve the resolution placing delinquent invoices on the 2025 summer tax bills.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the resolution placing delinquent invoices on the 2025 summer tax bills. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Resolution - Right of First Refusal

Recommendation: *Approve a resolution to exercise its right of first refusal option to take 19 parcels for future redevelopment and decline an additional 22 parcels.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve a resolution to exercise its right of first refusal taking 19 parcels for future redevelopment and decline an additional 22 parcels. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. Audit Services Agreement - Rehmann

Recommendation: *Approve the three-year agreement to engage Rehmann to provide audit services at a cost of \$100,000.00 for fiscal year 2024/25, \$105,000.00 for fiscal year 2025/26, and \$110,200.00 for fiscal year 2026/27; and authorization for the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate document in accordance with the Purchasing Coordinator.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the three-year agreement to engage Rehmann to provide audit services at a cost of \$100,000.00 for fiscal year 2024/25, \$105,000.00 for fiscal year 2025/26, and \$110,200.00 for fiscal year 2026/27; and authorization for the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate document in accordance with the Purchasing Coordinator. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. Funding Letters for Pension Systems

Recommendation: *Receive the actuarial valuations as of June 30, 2024, for the Act 345 Policemen's & Firemen's Retirement Plan, the Employees' Retirement System, and the Policemen's and Firemen's Retirement System, and approve the actuarial funding necessary for the fiscal year 2025/2026.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Davis to receive the actuarial valuations as of June 30, 2024, for the Act 345 Policemen's & Firemen's Retirement Plan, the Employees' Retirement System, and the Policemen's and Firemen's Retirement System, and approve the actuarial funding necessary for the fiscal year 2025/2026. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. Resolution Proposed Annual Budget for Fiscal Year 2025-2026

Recommendation: *Adoption of the Annual Budget Resolution for Fiscal Year 2025/26 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to sign the 2025 Tax Rate Request (form L-4029).*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to adopt the Annual Budget Resolution for Fiscal Year 2025/26 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to sign the 2025 Tax Rate Request. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. Ordinance -Nonunion Wage Table effective 7.1.2025

Recommendation: *Approve the first reading and advance to the second reading/final adoption an ordinance establishing the non-union wage table.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the first reading of an ordinance for non-union wage table.

Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

H. Contract Award - MLK Equality Trail Extension

Recommendation: *Approve the award of the contract for the MLK Equality Trail Extension on Mechanic Street from Detroit Street to Trail Street to Merlo Construction Company, Inc. of Milford, Michigan at a cost of \$298,052.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the award of the contract for the MLK Equality Trail Extension on Mechanic Street from Detroit Street to Trail Street to Merlo Construction Company of Milford, Michigan at a cost of \$298,052.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

I. Donation of vacant property – 225 W Biddle

Recommendation: *Accept the donation of vacant property at 225 W. Biddle Street (parcel # 4-047600000), approve the donation agreement and quit claim deed, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to accept the donation of vacant property at 225 W. Biddle Street. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

J. Resolution - Water and Wastewater Rate

Recommendation: *Approval of Option #3 for the fiscal years 2025/26 and 2026/27 Water and Wastewater Rate Resolution.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve Option #1 for the fiscal years 2025/26 and 2026/27 Water and Wastewater Rate Resolution.

Motion was made by Mayor Mahoney, seconded by Councilmember Davis to postpone the item until the next meeting (June 10, 2025). Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, and Davis (4). Nays: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Wood, and Forgrave (3). Motion carried.

K. Interagency Agreement between the City of Jackson and Leoni Twp.

Recommendation: *Approve the interagency agreement between the City of Jackson and Leoni Township, for building inspection and plan review services, and allow the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as may be required.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve the interagency agreement between the City of Jackson and Leoni Township, for building inspection and plan review services, and allow the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as may be required. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Forgrave (6). Nays: Councilmember Davis (1). Motion carried.

L. Sale of 1206 Deyo Street, PIN # 6-040600000.

Recommendation: *Approve the sale of 1206 Deyo Street, PIN # 6-040600000 to Adnan Baghal Investment LLC, located at 205 Page Ave, Jackson, MI. 49201 for two thousand dollars (\$2,000). Allow the City Manager and City Attorney to initiate the sales and development agreement consistent with City policies.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Davis to approve the sale of 1206 Deyo Street. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER’S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene did not offer comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 9:05 p.m.